



NIGERIAN PEOPLES AND CULTURE



NIGERIA'S POP CULTURE (MUSIC)

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LEARNING OBJECTIVE

At the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define the term “popular culture”.
- Discuss the historical evolution of the term “pop culture”.
- Examine the evolution of Nigeria’s pop culture.
- Assess the impact of popular culture on the larger Nigerian society.



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WHAT IS POPULAR CULTURE

Popular culture refers to the traditions and material culture of a particular society. In the modern West, pop culture refers to cultural products such as music, art, literature, fashion, dance, film, cyberculture, television, and radio consumed by most of a society's population.





WHAT IS POPULAR CULTURE

Popular culture refers to those types of media that have mass accessibility and appeal.

The term "popular culture" was coined in the mid-19th century and refers to the cultural traditions of the people, in contrast to the "official culture" of the state or governing classes.



THE RISE OF POPULAR CULTURE

- Scholars trace the origins of popular culture to the creation of the middle class generated by the Industrial Revolution.
- People who were configured into working classes and moved into urban environments began creating their own culture and distinct lifestyle.
- After the end of World War II, innovations in mass media led to significant cultural and social changes in the West.





THE RISE OF POPULAR CULTURE

The rise of popular culture coincided with the rise of capitalism; thus, newly invented goods were being marketed to different classes.

The meaning of popular culture then began to merge with that of mass culture, consumer culture, image culture, media culture, and culture created by manufacturers for mass consumption.



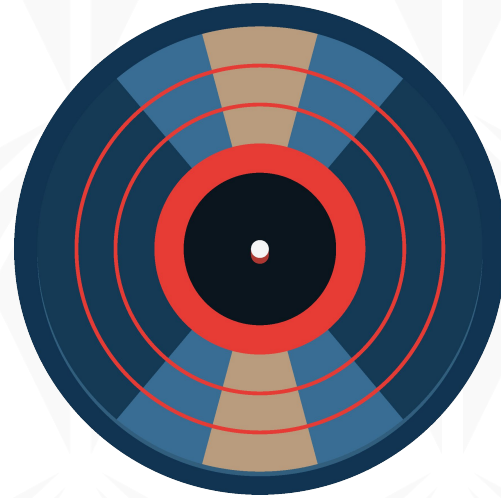
MID-LESSON QUESTION

What particular role do you think genre played in addressing social issues during the period of popular culture?



POPULAR MUSIC

Popular music refers to all contemporaneous music with broad, immediate, and implicitly transient attractiveness that appeals to a mass audience. Such music is quite receptive to people since they are familiar with its idioms and does not require guided listening.





POPULAR NIGERIAN MUSIC

Popular music primarily attracts urban dwellers, particularly the youth, who seek social entertainment and dancing experiences. It predominantly thrives in pubs and nightclubs.

The evolution of Nigerian popular music has been delimited into four epochal stages.



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THE EVOLUTION OF POPULAR NIGERIAN MUSIC



THE FIRST WAVE: 1950-67

The first wave was from the 1950s and 1960s. It was deeply traditional. This period saw the evolution of sounds like Juju, Apala, Nigerian Highlife, etc.

The popular artists of the time include I.K. Dairo and his Blue Spots, Haruna Ishola and his Group, E.C. Arinze, Sammy Akpabot and His All Stars, Godwin Omabuwu and his Sound Makers, Ganiyu Kale and His Guinea Mambo Orchestra, Sefiu Ayan, Kasumu Adio, and Ayinla Omowura, Bobby Benson, Jim Lawson & the Mayor's Dance Band, Dan Maraya, and many more.





THE FIRST WAVE: 1950-67

External influences such as Ghanaian Highlife, Caribbean calypso, and Mambo were prevalent.

This period was popular for its bands and stage performances.

Their music had a significant impact on the popular culture of that time as it influenced dressing, the pattern of social gathering, and also indicated class.

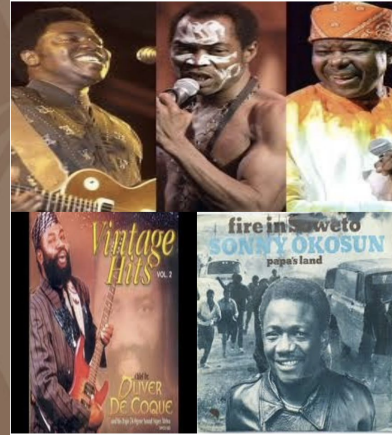




SECOND WAVE: 1967-80

Highlife regained popularity in the 1970s with musicians like Victor Olaiya, Osadebe, Oliver De Coque, Oriental Brother, Sunny Okosun, Victor Uwaifo, Orlando Owoh, and Christie Essien Igbokwe.

Afrobeat also became mainstream during this epoch, with Fela becoming a household name. He addressed social ills with his brand of music.





SECOND WAVE

This was a pivotal time because the Nigerian Civil War particularly affected Highlife music, which had gained popularity as feel-good and upper-class music.

In Ghana, from where it was borrowed, it was a musical genre that addressed social problems.

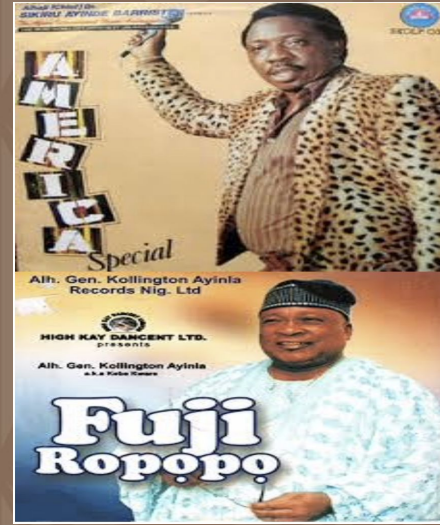




SECOND WAVE

Juju was also waxing strong at this time, with artists like Ebenezer Obey and King Sunny Ade blazing the trail. It was a song for the upper class.

Fuji also emerged as a fusion of Apala and Ajisari. It drew major influences from Islam and was mostly for the lower class. Sikiru Ayinde Barrister and Ayinla Kollington were famous Fuji musicians at the time.



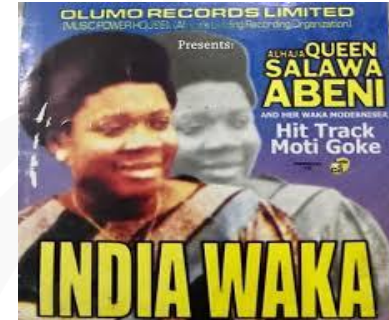


THIRD WAVE 1980-90

New sounds like Waka, Yo Pop, and Afro Juju were introduced during this period.

International record labels like Island Record signed Sunny Ade and Virgin Records signed Ebenezer Obey.

Salawa Abeni achieved fame with her Waka brand of music.



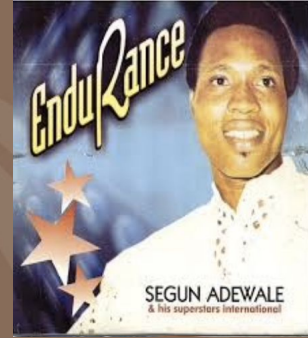
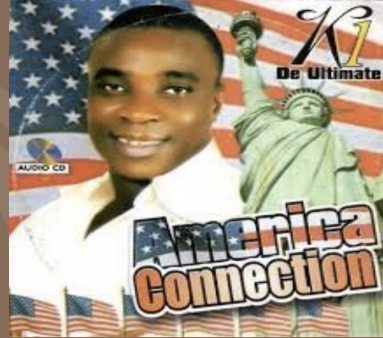


THIRD WAVE

Fuji also continued to grow at the time, with Wasiu Ayinde Marshall achieving fame.

Segun Adewale (Yo Pop); Shina Peters (Afro Juju) were also present during this period.

There was a yearning to appeal to an international audience, as this led to a greater fusion of international sounds and costumes into Nigerian songs.





THIRD WAVE

During the 3rd Wave, there were a number of artists who infused international sounds like Reggae, Calypso, rap, and R&B into their sound.

At this time, a lot of sounds came out of Ajegunle, with Junior and Pretty leading the charge with popular songs like Bolanle and Monika.





THIRD WAVE

Nigerian music was struggling with its identity at this time, and famous artists at this time included Oritz Williki, Blacky (Rosie), Majek Fashek, Mike Okri, Ras Kimono, Evi Edna Ogholi, etc.

There was a dwindling of Nigerian music at this time as the international record labels left, and Nigerian music was struggling for identity because it was sounding more American than Nigerian.

The rebuilding process began with the fourth wave.



FOURTH WAVE: 1992-TILL PRESENT

At this stage, the quest to sound more American than Nigerian continued. The artists at this time appealed to the youth as there was a rarity of local languages in their lyrics.

Music groups like Remedies, Plantashun Boiz, Styl Plus, Psquare, and Mohit's Crew all blazed the trail at this time.

Over time, Nigerian pop culture began to infuse local languages and styles into their craft to create a unique sound and style.



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SUMMARY



SUMMARY

Popular culture refers to the traditions and material culture of a particular society.

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REFERENCES/FURTHER READING

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THANK YOU